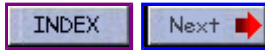


C Programming

An introduction



A SIMPLE C PROGRAM

The following program is written in the C programming language.

```
#include <stdio.h>

main()
{
    printf("Programming in C is easy.\n");
}
```

Sample Program Output

Programming in C is easy.

—

A NOTE ABOUT C PROGRAMS

In C, lowercase and uppercase characters are very important! All commands in C must be lowercase. The C programs starting point is identified by the word

```
main()
```

This informs the computer as to where the program actually starts. The brackets that follow the keyword *main* indicate that there are no arguments supplied to this program ([this will be examined later on](#)).

The two braces, { and }, signify the begin and end segments of the program. The purpose of the statment

```
#include <stdio.h>
```

is to allow the use of the *printf* statement to provide program output. Text to be displayed by *printf()* must be enclosed in double quotes. The program has only one statement

```
printf("Programming in C is easy.\n");
```

printf() is actually a function (procedure) in C that is used for printing variables and text. Where text appears in double quotes "", it is printed without modification. There are some exceptions however. This has to do with the \ and % characters. These characters are [modifier's](#), and for the present the \ followed by the n character represents a newline character. Thus the program prints

```
Programming in C is easy.
```

and the cursor is set to the beginning of the next line. As we shall see later on, what follows the `\` character will determine what is printed, ie, a tab, clear screen, clear line etc. Another important thing to remember is that all C statements are terminated by a semi-colon ;

[Click here for a pascal comparison.](#)

Summary of major points so far

- program execution begins at *main()*
 - keywords are written in lower-case
 - statements are terminated with a semi-colon
 - text strings are enclosed in double quotes
 - C is case sensitive, use lower-case and try not to capitalise variable names
 - `\n` means position the cursor on the beginning of the next line
 - *printf()* can be used to display text to the screen
 - the curly braces { } define the beginning and end of a program block
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